



CREMA ITALIA™
— ITALIAN ARTISAN COFFEE —

Brand & Document Standards

Standard del marchio e dei documenti

ISSUED BY	AUDIENCE	STATUS
Crema Italia, LLC Lutz, Florida, USA	Internal team & brand contributors	Authoritative Version 2.3

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THE CANONICAL REFERENCE

Crema Italia Brand & Document Standards

Version 2.3 · August 2026 · Owner: Crema Italia, LLC · Lutz, Florida, USA · cremaitalia.com ·

Applies to: all Crema Italia documents (DOCX, PDF, Markdown), web pages, decks, email templates, and partner-facing collateral.

This is the canonical reference. When you ask a tool to build a Crema Italia document, slide, or web page, point it at this file and the accompanying `Crema Italia Brand CSS.css` and the finalized logo files in `Logo Assets/`. The look established by the Roaster Onboarding & Partnership Guide is the visual reference; this document codifies it.

WHAT CHANGED IN V2.3 (2026-08-22)

Two **accessible text tokens** added to §3.4, and one error in that section corrected. A 16-page audit of the storefront found **127 rendered instances** of text below WCAG AA, and two colours accounted for all of them: Crema Gold and Mute, used at small sizes. This Standard had already predicted the first case and the site broke the rule anyway; it had also *sanctioned* the second, listing Mute at 3.7 : 1 as suitable for captions and fine print, which are exactly the sizes it fails at. The remedy is a pair of darkened siblings used only below 24 px, leaving Crema Gold and Mute unchanged everywhere they already pass. §3.5 now also records the **Bottega accent** as a sanctioned, scoped exception rather than drift.

WHAT CHANGED IN V2.2 (2026-08-21)

One addition to **Voice & tone**: card copy may be terser than detail copy for the same fact, and that difference is a deliberate register choice rather than a discrepancy to reconcile. Substance must still match everywhere. Copy-only; colour, type, logo and layout are unchanged.

WHAT CHANGED IN V2.1 (2026-07-14)

One voice rule added (§9): **no em-dashes in customer-facing copy**, with the semicolon → spaced-hyphen and trailing → ellipsis substitutions. Color, type, logo, and layout grid are unchanged from v2.0; this is a copy-only minor revision.

WHAT CHANGED IN V2.0 (ARTIST REBRAND, 2026-07-01)

A graphic artist delivered the finalized **Crema Italia™** mark (vector master + full lockup set) for the trademark filing. Two brand systems were revised as a result: the **palette** — Espresso Brown is now `#55331B` and Crema Gold is `#B88348` (replacing the former `#3B1F12` / `#C46A1F`); and the **type** — the wordmark is set in Montecatini Pro (in the logo art only), and live web/document headings use **Marcellus**, ending the earlier Cormorant→Lora display-font history. Green, red, cream, and Inter body type are unchanged.

1 · Brand essence

Crema Italia is a small, selective importer of artisan Italian coffee. The visual language must read as:

- **Editorial** — long-form, considered, like a fine-press book. Not e-commerce loud.
- **Italian** — a quiet nod to the tricolore (green / white / red) without ever shouting it.
- **Warm** — cream and coffee tones, never stark white, never grey corporate.
- **Bilingual-ready** — every layout must comfortably hold an English column and an Italian column side by side.

When in doubt: fewer elements, more whitespace, smaller logo, larger margins.

2 · Logo

Files: the finalized artist mark lives in `Logo Assets/` — a vector master (`Art Files/*.ai`) plus matched `EPS/` , `PDF/` , `SVG/` , `PNG/` exports and generated `Web/` derivatives. Three lockups — **main** (vertical), **horizontal**, and **favicon** (cup only) — each in a light-background and a dark-background version.

- **Trademark:** the mark is **Crema Italia™**. The ™ sits as a cap-height superscript after the final "A" in "ITALIA." Never use ® — Crema Italia is not federally registered yet.
- **Clear space:** at least the height of the wordmark "C" on every side. Never crop the tricolore arcs.
- **Minimum size:** print 25 mm wide; screen 120 px wide. A favicon-only crop of the cup is acceptable below 120 px.
- **On dark backgrounds:** use the dark-background lockup (cream wordmark), e.g. `PNG/CI Logo for Dark Background - Transparent.png` — never the light mark recolored. Never re-color the cup.
- **Don't:** stretch, rotate, or add drop-shadows; place on photographs without a solid backing; re-typeset the wordmark. Master edits happen in the `.ai` ; re-export the others.

3 · Color system

All colors are derived from the finalized logo and its artist spec sheet. Use the role, not the hex name, when prompting.

3.1 Primary palette

Role	Hex	RGB	Where it lives
 Background — Cream	#FBF8F1	251, 248, 241	Page background, document body, hero sections
 Surface — Ivory	#FFFFFF	255, 255, 255	Tables, callout cards, web cards on cream
 Espresso — Brown	#55331B	85, 51, 27	Body text, H1 headings, wordmark
 Espresso — Soft Brown	#6B4A38	107, 74, 56	Muted / secondary body, captions (interim)
 Crema — Gold	#B88348	184, 131, 72	H2 / sub-headings, accents, links, key numbers
 Crema Light	#E8A86A	232, 168, 106	Hover states, light fills, chart shades (interim)

Interim tokens (Espresso Soft, Crema Light, and hover #9C6E3C) are harmonizations pending re-derivation from the two artist hero tones.

3.2 Italian flag accents (use sparingly)

Role	Hex	RGB	Where it lives
 Tricolore Green	#0E7A3A	14, 122, 58	Top-left page rule, footer bar, ENGLISH column markers
 Tricolore Red	#C8342B	200, 52, 43	Top-right page rule, footer bar, ITALIANO column markers

The flag colors are **decorative rules, never large fills**. Think: a pencil-thick rule across the top of the page, a 6 mm strip at the foot of the cover. Never block colors.

3.3 Neutral / structural

Role	Hex	Use
 Hairline	#D9D2C2	Column dividers, table borders, footer rules
 Mute	#8C7E6A	Page numbers, footer text, eyebrow labels (ENGLISH, ITALIANO)
 Ink soft	#5A4A3F	Long-form body text where pure brown is too heavy

3.4 Contrast — non-negotiable

Pair (on Cream #FBF8F1)	Ratio	Status
Espresso Brown #55331B	10.6 : 1	AAA
Espresso Soft #6B4A38	7.4 : 1	AAA
Ink soft #5A4A3F	8.0 : 1	AAA
Crema Gold #B88348	3.1 : 1	Large display only — ≥ 18 pt / 24 px (or bold ≥ 14 pt)
Mute #8C7E6A	3.7 : 1	Large display only — see the correction below
Crema Gold text #94693A	4.6 : 1	AA — gold at any size, incl. body and small text
Mute text #7D705E	4.6 : 1	AA — captions, fine print, metadata
Crema Gold fill #96683A	4.6 : 1	AA — for Cream text set on a gold fill (buttons, badges)

Rule: Crema Gold #B88348 and Mute #8C7E6A clear WCAG only for **large text** (≥ 24 px, or bold ≥ 18.66 px). Keep them for large headings, rules, decorative fills and short bold accent runs. **Below 24 px, use the darkened sibling instead:** #94693A for gold, #7D705E for mute. Same hue, same saturation, less lightness — the difference is barely perceptible side by side and it is the difference between legible and not for a reader with moderate vision loss.

Correction (v2.3). Earlier versions listed Mute at 3.7 : 1 as suitable for “*captions / fine print only*.” That was backwards: captions and fine print are precisely the small sizes where 3.7 : 1 fails. The Standard sanctioned a failing usage, and the storefront followed it faithfully.

The direction reverses on dark grounds. A darker token raises contrast on cream and *lowers* it on brown. On Espresso or any dark band, correct by going **lighter** — Crema Light #E9AB6E or Cream — never by reaching for the darkened text tokens above. (Crema Light was #E8A86A through v2.2; it is nudged here because it fell 0.05 short of AA on the lightest brown ground in use.)

3.5 Don't introduce new colors

If a chart or web feature seems to need a new hue, derive it from Crema Light, Espresso, or a desaturated Tricolore Green. The brand should never sprout a sixth or seventh accent.

THE ONE SANCTIONED EXCEPTION: BOTTEGA

La Bottega wears a cool slate scheme rather than the espresso/cream/gold of the four coffee shelves, because it is deliberately the shop apart: equipment and merchandise, never subscriber-discounted, not part of the coffee catalogue. Approved 2026-08-22.

`#1A1A2A` and `#3A3A5A` (hero gradient), `#2A2A3A` (shelf badge), `#C8C8D8` (tint on those grounds). **Scoped to Bottega surfaces only** — never on a coffee shelf, a product page for coffee, or any shared chrome. It must live in named tokens: it went unnoticed for months precisely because it was written as an inline style and two hardcoded values, which no palette audit of a stylesheet can see.

4 · Typography

Two live families plus the logo face. Hold this line — the document brand depends on it.

4.1 The pairing

Role	Family	Where to use
Logo wordmark	Montecatini Pro (Normale Semi-Bold)	Logo artwork only — already outlined in the files. Commercial font; licensing unconfirmed for any use beyond the outlined mark.
Display & Headings	Marcellus (serif, weight 400)	Cover title, H1, section headings, web/document display. The free Google-Font stand-in for Montecatini.
Body & UI	Inter (sans, 400 / 500 / 600)	All body text, tables, captions, web UI, buttons, tagline.

Why this pairing: Marcellus echoes the classical Roman capitals of the wordmark and reads as considered and Italian without theatrics; Inter is a calm, neutral workhorse that handles bilingual copy and small sizes without strain. Both are free, web-safe, and embed cleanly in PDF.

Marcellus is roman-only — it ships a single 400 weight with no italic. Two consequences: (1) heading *hierarchy is set by size, not weight*; use bold Inter for emphasis within text. (2) The English-vs-Italian cue is now carried by the **ENGLISH / ITALIANO** eyebrow label and column position — *not* by italic display type. Reserve italics (Inter Italic) for references and short foreign words.

4.2 Sub-heading exception

H2 sub-headings are set in **Inter SemiBold (600) in Crema Gold**, not in serif. Keep this rule — it visually separates major editorial titles (Marcellus, brown) from in-page section markers (Inter, gold).

4.3 Word & PDF — exact specifications

Element	Family	Wt	Size	Color	Lead
Cover title	Marcellus	400	30–36 pt	Espresso #55331B	1.1
Cover sub-title (Italian)	Marcellus	400	15–18 pt	Espresso Soft #6B4A38	1.2
H1 page heading	Marcellus	400	22–24 pt	Espresso #55331B	1.15
H2 sub-heading	Inter	600	13 pt	Crema Gold #B88348	1.25
Eyebrow (ENGLISH/ITALIANO)	Inter	600	8.5 pt, +0.12 em	Crema Gold #B88348	1.0
Body	Inter	400	10.5 pt	Espresso #55331B	1.45
Body emphasis	Inter	600	10.5 pt	Espresso #55331B	1.45
Caption / reference	Inter Italic	400	9 pt	Espresso Soft #6B4A38	1.4
Table header	Inter	600	9.5 pt	Cream on Espresso	1.3
Table body	Inter	400	9.5 pt	Espresso #55331B	1.4
Footer / page no.	Inter	400/500	8.5 pt	Mute #8C7E6A	1.3

4.4 Web — exact specifications

Element	Family	Wt	Size	Color
Hero / cover	Marcellus	400	4.5 rem / 72 px	Espresso
H1	Marcellus	400	2.5 rem / 40 px	Espresso
H2	Inter	600	1.125 rem / 18 px	Crema Gold
H3	Inter	600	1 rem / 16 px	Espresso
Body	Inter	400	1.0625 rem / 17 px	Espresso
Small / caption	Inter	400	0.875 rem / 14 px	Espresso Soft
Eyebrow	Inter	600	0.75 rem / 12 px, +0.12 em, uppercase	Crema Gold

4.5 Body type rules

- **Measure:** 65–75 characters per line. In a two-column bilingual Letter layout this lands at ~3.1 in / 7.9 cm column width.
- **Paragraph spacing:** 6 pt before, no first-line indent. Never both indent and space.
- **Hyphenation:** off for English and Italian; a slightly ragged right reads better, and Italian breaks awkwardly.
- **Numerals:** lining, tabular in tables and prices; proportional elsewhere.

- **Italics carry meaning** — Italian-language references and short foreign words (Inter Italic). Don't italicize for emphasis; use bold.

4.6 Font fallbacks

Display: "Marcellus", "Georgia", serif · Body: "Inter", "Helvetica Neue", "Arial", sans-serif . For Word documents, ship Marcellus and Inter as embedded named styles; if a recipient lacks them, Word falls back to Georgia and Calibri — close enough to preserve hierarchy.

5 · Page layout

5.1 Document grid (Letter — 8.5 × 11 in)

Margin	Size
Top / Bottom	0.85 in
Left & Right	0.75 in
Gutter (between bilingual columns)	0.4 in
Column width (each)	3.55 in

5.2 Page chrome

- **Top:** two short rules — green #0E7A3A left, red #C8342B right, ~1.6 in long, 1.2 pt thick. Wordmark “Crema Italia” sits left in 9–11 pt Marcellus; running title sits right in 9 pt Inter.
- **Bottom:** single hairline rule #D9D2C2, 0.5 pt. Below it, footer “Crema Italia, LLC · Lutz, Florida, USA · cremaitalia.com” left, “Page N” right, both 8.5 pt Inter Mute.
- **Cover:** logo top-center, centered title block, three-column meta strip (Issued by / Audience / Status) above a hairline, and a 6 mm green-cream-red flag strip at the foot.

5.3 Bilingual columns

- Always English left, Italian right.
- Column eyebrow labels (ENGLISH, ITALIANO) in Crema Gold, set above the H1.
- A 0.5 pt hairline runs the full text height between columns.
- Because Marcellus has no italic, the English/Italian distinction is carried by the eyebrow label and column position — not by italic display type (a change from v1.0).

5.4 Lists, tables, callouts

- **Bulleted lists:** • (U+2022), 0.18 in indent, 0.12 in hanging indent. No nested bullets in body content; if you need a second level, restructure into a table.
- **Tables:** Espresso-brown header bar #55331B with cream text; body rows on Ivory #FFFFFF; row separators #D9D2C2. No vertical lines.
- **Callouts:** cream box #FBF8F1 on ivory page, 1 pt left rule in Crema Gold #B88348, 0.25 in inner padding.
- **References:** italic caption style, prefixed “Reference:” / “Riferimento:”.

6 · Web styling

The accompanying `Crema Italia Brand CSS.css` (v1.2) is the canonical implementation. It exposes every value above as a CSS custom property and includes ready-made classes for

`.eyebrow`, `.bilingual`, `.callout`, `.flag-rule`, and `.btn-primary`.

6.1 Web rules

- Max content width 72 ch for long-form, 1120 px for landing pages.
- Load fonts: `Marcellus` + `Inter` from Google Fonts.
- Buttons: Crema Gold fill, Cream text, 8 px radius, 12 px / 24 px padding, no shadow.
- Hover: darken Crema by ~8% — `--ci-crema-hover: #9C6E3C`.
- Focus ring: 2 px Crema Gold with 2 px Cream offset — required for accessibility.
- Never animate gratuitously. A 200 ms color transition on links is the ceiling.

7 · Data visualization

- Single-series: Crema Gold `#B88348`.
- Two-series: Crema Gold `#B88348` and Espresso Soft `#6B4A38`.
- Three-to-five series: Crema Gold, Espresso Soft, Tricolore Green `#0E7A3A`, Espresso Brown `#55331B`, Crema Light `#E8A86A` — in that order.
- Background: Cream. Gridlines: Hairline `#D9D2C2`, dashed, 0.5 pt. Axis labels: Inter 9 pt, Mute.
- Title above the chart in Inter SemiBold 11 pt Espresso — state the insight, not the variable.
- No 3D, no pie charts with more than 3 wedges, no dual axes.

8 · Imagery & photography

- **Style:** natural light, low saturation, narrow depth of field. Espresso cups, roasting drums, hands at work, Tuscan landscape.
- **Don't:** stock photos of generic baristas, vector illustrations, emoji, decorative coffee-bean borders.
- **Treatment:** images sit on Cream with a 1 px Hairline border and 0.25 in margin. No drop-shadows.
- **Aspect ratios:** 3:2 landscape product shots, 1:1 roaster portraits, 16:9 hero web banners.

9 · Voice & tone (brief)

- **Plain, direct, deferential.** “We choose a small number of roasters whose work represents the craft of Italian roasting at its best.” Not: “We hand-pick the world’s most exclusive coffee artisans.”
- **Bilingual parity.** Every roaster-facing artifact ships in English and Italian. Italian is the controlling version when handed to an Italian roaster.
- **Honour formal address in Italian.** Use Voi / Vi / Vostro, capitalized.
- **Numbers and units.** Always include both metric (250 g, 1 kg) and U.S. customary (8.82 oz, 2.20 lb) on weight references.
- **No em-dashes in customer-facing copy.** Storefront and marketing text — product and page copy, forms, email templates, the coming-soon page — never uses the em-dash, which reads as machine-written. Where a semicolon would serve, use a spaced hyphen (-); where a sentence trails into a follow-on thought, use an ellipsis (...); if a case is genuinely ambiguous, ask. Customer-facing copy only — internal documents, this one included, may still use them.
- **Terse on cards, fuller on detail.** The same fact may be worded differently on a product card and on the product page, and usually should be. A card is scanned at a glance and earns brevity; a detail page is read and can afford the fuller sentence. Where the two differ, that is a deliberate register choice, not a discrepancy to be reconciled - do not “correct” one to match the other. What must never differ is the *substance*: a rule, a number or a promise says the same thing in both places, or one of them is wrong.

10 · File naming & versioning

- Documents: Crema_Italia_<Topic>_v<MAJOR>.<MINOR>.{docx|pdf} .
- Logos: organized by lockup and format in Logo Assets/ — Art Files/ (.ai master), EPS/ , PDF/ , SVG/ , PNG/ , Web/ . Lockups: main, horizontal, favicon — each light and dark.
- CSS / templates: Crema Italia Brand CSS.css , kept under version control.
- Increment minor (2.0 → 2.1) for copy fixes. Increment major (2.x → 3.0) for any change to color, type, or layout grid.
- Always use the greatest version-number variant of a file (_v2 > _v1).

11 · Quick checklist before sharing any artifact

- Logo: correct file & lockup, clear space respected, minimum size honored, ™ present (never ®).
- Background is Cream #FBF8F1 , not white (except inside tables/cards).
- Headings in Marcellus, body in Inter; wordmark artwork only in Montecatini.

- Crema Gold used only on large headings, links, key numerals — never body or small text.
- Tricolore green and red appear only as thin rules, never as fills.
- Bilingual layout: English left, Italian right; English/Italian cue via eyebrow label, not italic.
- Footer carries “Crema Italia, LLC · Lutz, Florida, USA · cremaitalia.com”; page numbers present.
- Body type ≥ 10.5 pt (print) / 17 px (web); contrast checked (gold large-only).
- No introduced colors, no decorative graphics, no stretched logo.

Document maintained by Crema Italia, LLC. Companion files: [Crema Italia Brand CSS.css](#) (v1.2), the finalized logo set in [Logo Assets/](#), and this document’s editable source [Crema_Italia_Brand_Standards_v2.3.html](#). Supersedes Brand Standards v2.2 (August 2026), v2.1 (July 2026), v2.0 (July 2026) and v1.0 (May 2026).